Total Drain Group – Pipe Management Australia

MN-15028

Phase 1 Determination

Acquisition may be put into effect

13 August 2026

1. Determination and statement of reasons

Notified acquisition	Total Drain Group Pty Ltd, trading as TDG Environmental (**TDG**), proposes to acquire 100% of the shares of Utility Management Group Pty Ltd, trading as Pipe Management Australia (**PMA**) (the **Acquisition**).
Determination	The Australian Competition and Consumer Commission has determined under section 51ABZE(1) of the *Competition and Consumer Act 2010* (Cth) that the Acquisition may be put into effect.
Parties to the Acquisition	The acquirer, TDG, is a provider of stormwater and wastewater collection, maintenance and waste recycling services in Australia and New Zealand. The target, PMA, is a provider of stormwater and wastewater collection and maintenance (in particular relining) services operating primarily in New South Wales and Queensland. TDG and PMA are together referred to as the **Parties**.
Overlap between the Parties	The Parties overlap in New South Wales and Queensland (and to a minimal extent, Victoria and the Australian Capital Territory) in the supply of liquid waste collection and maintenance services to councils and water authorities in relation to stormwater and wastewater, and, to a more limited extent, infrastructure and commercial and industrial customers. Liquid waste collection and maintenance services comprise a range of services relating to the inspection, cleaning, maintenance and rehabilitation of drainage infrastructure. These include jetting/vacuuming, gross pollutant trap servicing, non-destructive digging, pipe remediation and relining, CCTV inspection, and waste transport and disposal.
Reasons for determination	When making a determination in Phase 1, the Australian Competition and Consumer Commission (**ACCC**) undertakes a competition assessment and considers whether it is appropriate for an acquisition to be approved or subject to further assessment in Phase 2 in accordance with section 51ABZJ of the *Competition and Consumer Act 2010* (Cth) (the **Act**). In doing so, the ACCC must have regard to the object of the Act and all relevant matters, including the interests of consumers. For more information about the ACCC's approach to considering notified acquisitions, see the ACCC's merger assessment guidelines and interim merger process guidelines. In conducting its competition assessment, the ACCC has considered the information and documents that were submitted with the notification form, information from third parties, and publicly available information. The ACCC has determined that the Acquisition may be put into effect as it considers that the Acquisition is unlikely to have the effect of substantially lessening competition in any market. In reaching its decision, and based on the material before it, the ACCC makes the following findings. • Some competitors raised concerns that the Acquisition would

	combine two competitors and reduce customers' choice of suppliers. However, customers of the Parties considered they would continue to have access to a range of alternative suppliers post-Acquisition. • The merged entity would continue to face competition from multiple alternative suppliers of liquid waste collection and maintenance services, across all services and geographic areas in which the Parties currently overlap.
Applications for review	A notifying party, or other person who has been allowed to do so by the Australian Competition Tribunal, may apply for review if they are dissatisfied with the determination. Pursuant to section 100C of the Act, applications for review of the determination are to be made to the Australian Competition Tribunal before the end of 14 calendar days after this statement of reasons was included on the ACCC's Acquisitions Register. To confirm whether there has been any application for review, please contact the Australian Competition Tribunal.

Determination made by Commissioner Williams pursuant to a delegation under section 25(1) of the Act